



HIRING INSIGHTS • GERMANY

WERKSTUDENT QUICK CHECKLIST

2026 EDITION • ONE-SITTING ACTION SHEET

A short, practical action sheet for engineering students in Germany who need to move fast. Print it, tick the boxes, and apply this week.

How to use this checklist

This checklist is meant to be used **after** the main *Werkstudent Starter Guide*. It is short, practical, and easy to act on in one sitting. A student should be able to finish this checklist and know exactly what to do next.

i**Best used as**

A **first reply** to a student's DM, followed by a role-specific CV or portfolio resource. Don't send everything at once — one guide, one checklist, one CV sample is enough.

The six steps inside

- 01** Before applying — set up your foundation
- 02** Application kit — the four files you send
- 03** What to say in a DM or first email
- 04** What not to do — instant filters
- 05** Best student tracks to target
- 06** One-day execution plan

01 Before applying

Five foundations to set up before sending a single application. Tick each box only when it is fully done.



Confirm university enrolment.

You need a valid *Immatrikulationsbescheinigung* — the role is legally tied to active student status.



Pick ONE target track.

Automation, Embedded, Mechanical, Data, or Robotics. Generalists get filtered out fast.



Make a one-page CV.

PDF only. Reverse-chronological. Headline = *Branch* + *Target role* + *Top 3 tools*.



Add 2–3 proof items.

Project, report, GitHub repo, CAD file, simulation, or dashboard. Two clean proofs beat ten unfinished ones.



Write a simple headline.

Example: “*B.Sc. Mechatronics • Werkstudent Automation • TIA Portal, Python, ROS*”.



Quick check

If you cannot explain every line on your CV in 30 seconds, it is not ready. Cut anything you can't defend.

02 Application kit

Send exactly four artefacts. Each has one job. No bundles, no zip files.

File	Purpose
CV (1 page, PDF)	Shows fit, tools, and project proof. Branch + target role + tools in the headline. Skills grouped by category. 2–3 projects with measurable outcomes.
Cover letter (½ page)	Explains <i>why this role</i> and <i>why this company</i> . Avoid generic motivation. Name the team or product. State availability and earliest start date.
Portfolio link	GitHub, personal site, Notion page, or a single PDF. Pin the most relevant project. The recruiter must be able to verify your work in 60 seconds.
Transcript / enrolment certificate	Provide when asked. The <i>Immatrikulationsbescheinigung</i> is often required to issue the contract — have it ready as a PDF.

File-naming convention

- **CV_FirstnameLastname_Werkstudent_Track.pdf** — e.g. *CV_Anna_Schmidt_Werkstudent_Automation.pdf*
- **CoverLetter_FirstnameLastname_Company.pdf**
- **Portfolio_FirstnameLastname.pdf** (or a clean URL)
- **Enrolment_FirstnameLastname.pdf**



Recruiter tip

Keep total attachment size under **5 MB**. Many corporate inboxes auto-reject larger messages and you'll never know your application didn't arrive.

03 What to say in a DM or first email

Use a short, structured opener. Recruiters and engineers receive dozens of student messages — the ones that get answered are clear, specific, and respectful of time.

The four lines that must be in your message

- **1.** I am looking for Werkstudent roles in **[track]**.
- **2.** I have worked on **[project]** using **[tools]**.
- **3.** I am available for part-time work (~20h/week) alongside my studies.
- **4.** Here is my CV and portfolio <link>. Thank you for considering my application.

Copy-paste template

“Hi [Name],

I'm a [degree] student at [university] looking for Werkstudent roles in **[track]**. I have worked on **[project]** using **[tools]** and I'm available for ~20 hours per week alongside my studies, with an earliest start date of **[date]**.

My CV and portfolio are attached. I'd be glad to discuss how I can contribute to your team.

Best regards,
[Your name]”

Tone & length

- Keep the whole message under **120 words**.
- One paragraph for context, one for ask, one to close.
- Address the person by name where possible. “*Dear Hiring Team*” is fine if you can't find one.
- Match the language of the posting — apply in German if the posting is in German.

04 What not to do

Each of these is an instant filter at most German engineering firms. Avoid them and you are already ahead of half the applicants.

- ✗ **Do not send a generic PDF bundle.** Five attachments of motivational PDFs signal that the candidate has not understood the role.
- ✗ **Do not claim skills you cannot explain.** If TensorFlow is on your CV, expect an interview question about it on day one.
- ✗ **Do not send a long message without role focus.** A 600-word personal essay is closed in three seconds.
- ✗ **Do not hide the fact that you are a student.** Werkstudent *requires* active enrolment — concealing it gets contracts cancelled later.
- ✗ **Do not ask about salary in the first message.** Discuss compensation after the screening call, not before.
- ✗ **Do not mass-apply with no customisation.** Recruiters share notes — if the same letter lands at five companies in one industry, all five reject it.
- ✗ **Do not lie about German level.** A 60-second phone call exposes it. State your actual CEFR level.
- ✗ **Do not chase aggressively.** One polite follow-up after 7 days is enough. Three follow-ups in three days gets you blacklisted.

✓ DO

- Tailor every message to the specific company.
- Lead with proof: 2 projects > a long skills list.
- Apply in the language of the posting.
- Follow up *once* after 7 days, then move on.
- Track every application in a spreadsheet.

✗ DON'T

- Send a 5-PDF generic bundle.
- Inflate skills or languages.
- Hide your student status.
- Open with a salary question.
- Chase aggressively after 24–48 hours.

05 Best student tracks to target

Five tracks dominate Werkstudent hiring in German engineering. Pick one. Search the exact keyword in postings — German job boards are literal.

1	Automation / PLC Typical work • PLC programming (Siemens TIA, Codesys) • HMI development, factory automation	Companies hiring SIEMENS • FESTO • ABB • BOSCH
2	Embedded Systems Typical work • Firmware testing, hardware validation • Embedded C/C++, microcontroller bring-up	Companies hiring BOSCH • Continental • Infineon
3	Robotics / Mechatronics Typical work • ROS, motion planning, vision • Integration of sensors and actuators	Companies hiring KUKA • ABB • Festo
4	Mechanical Design Typical work • CAD modelling (CATIA, NX, SolidWorks) • Drawings, GD&T, product development	Companies hiring BMW • Mercedes-Benz • Schaeffler
5	Data / Digital Engineering Typical work • Python, SQL, ETL pipelines • Dashboards (Power BI, Plotly), process automation	Companies hiring BOSCH • SIEMENS • SAP

06 One-day execution plan

If you have a single focused day to set this up, here is the order. Each block is timed — keep moving.

Morning • 90 min PICK & POSITION	Choose one track. Rewrite your LinkedIn headline and CV title to match: <i>Branch</i> + <i>Target role</i> + <i>Top 3 tools</i> . Delete anything off-track.
Morning • 60 min BUILD THE CV	One page, PDF. Reverse-chronological. Skills grouped by category. 2–3 projects with measurable outcomes.
Afternoon • 60 min POLISH THE PORTFOLIO	Clean up one GitHub repo or Notion page. Add a README: what, why, how, result. Pin it to the top of your profile.
Afternoon • 90 min MAP THE MARKET	Find 10 active Werkstudent postings in your track. Save the links. Highlight the keywords and tools that repeat.
Evening • 60 min SEND THE FIRST 5	Customise each cover letter (2 sentences is enough). Send. Log in your tracking spreadsheet. Schedule the follow-up for day 7.
★	Repeat this rhythm Day 2 onward: 5–10 tailored applications per week , one polite follow-up at day 7, weekly review of what's working. That's the whole loop.

Official reference

This checklist follows guidance from **Make it in Germany**, the federal portal for skilled workers and students. The portal states that students can generally work up to **20 hours per week** during the lecture period, with greater flexibility during semester breaks, subject to the overall annual limit of **140 full days** (or 280 half days).

20 h MAX / WEEK DURING LECTURES	FULL DURING SEMESTER BREAKS	140 FULL DAYS PER YEAR	280 HALF DAYS PER YEAR
--	--	----------------------------------	----------------------------------

Always verify before signing a contract

- Check the current rules at **make-it-in-germany.com**.
- Read the working-hour conditions on your own **residence permit**.
- Confirm whether any required internship (*Pflichtpraktikum*) is excluded from the day count.
- Ask the employer's HR team in writing if anything is unclear — they answer this question constantly.

Companion guide

For the long-form version of this material — legal context, employer priorities, search strategy, a 30-day plan, and an FAQ — read the **Germany Werkstudent Starter Guide 2026**. Use this checklist for speed; use the guide for depth.

Bottom line



Pick one track. Build one one-page CV. Ship one proof project. Send five tailored applications. Track everything. Repeat weekly. That is the entire system.